The lpalign Package

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Published as lpalign v1.4 final on June 28th 2026

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Abstract

This is a collection of macros that I developed while writing my dissertation. They are mostly focused on displaying, naming and referencing mathematical programming problems. The lpalign environment macro formats math programs for legibility in both code and display. The named paragraph and sub-equation macros are useful in any document which defines and references multiple problems, algorithms or multi-line environments.

Contents

1 Installation

Copy lpalign.sty to the same directory as your main .tex file and add the command `\usepackage{lpalign}` to your preamble. The amsmath and expl3 packages are required but will also be added by the above command. I recommend using these macros in conjunction with the hyperref package so that custom tags/references are clickable.

2 The lpalign Environment

lpalign is an environment macro built on the alignat environment from the amsmath package. It formats mathematical programs so that they are legible in code as well as in the final pdf. Its primary function is to automatically format and position the 'sense' (maximize or minimize) and 'subject to' terms within a gutter to the left of the alignat body. These terms are aligned with the objective and first constraint respectively.

The lpalign environment takes two arguments—`<sense>` and `<objective>`—along with several optional keys:

`vars` – subscript on the 'sense' term. Commonly used to state variables and ranges.

`vars-style` – font style for the `vars` value. Defaults to `\scriptstyle`.

`st` – text used for the 'subject to' term. Defaults to `s.t.`.

`objective-sep` – controls the spacing between objective function and the first constraint. The default value of `0em` can be changed during package load by the `lp_objective-sep` option.
e.g. `\usepackage[lp_objective-sep=XXem]{lpalign}`.

`qualifier-sep` – controls the spacing between constraint body and the qualifier (for-all) term. The default value of `2em` can be changed during package load by the `lp_qualifier-sep` option.
e.g. `\usepackage[lp_qualifier-sep=XXem]{lpalign}`.

`gutter-sep` – controls the spacing between 'sense'/'subject to' terms and the constraint body. The default value of `0.75em` can be changed during package load by the `lp_gutter-sep` option.
e.g. `\usepackage[lp_gutter-sep=XXem]{lpalign}`.

`sense-shift` – adds a vertical shift to the 'sense' term.

`st-shift` – adds a vertical shift to the 'subject to' term.

The lpalign* environment is identical without printing equation reference tags unless explicitly called for by the `\tag` command.

```
\begin{lpalign}{Maximize}{\mathbf{c}^\top\mathbf{x}}
  A\mathbf{x} &\le \mathbf{b}  \\
   \mathbf{x} &\ge \mathbf{0}
\end{lpalign}
```

$$\downarrow$$

$$\begin{lpalign}{Maximize}{\mathbf{c}^\top\mathbf{x}}
  A\mathbf{x} &\le \mathbf{b} \\
   \mathbf{x} &\ge \mathbf{0}
\end{lpalign}$$

Just like in vanilla alignat, ampersands `&` control alignment; the constraint rows will be aligned at the ampersand.

```
  &Ax+s = b+0 \\     Ax+s &= b+0 \\     Ax+s = b+0& \\
  &x,s \ge 0          x,s &\ge 0          x,s \ge 0&
```

$$\downarrow$$

$$\begin{lpalign}{max}{c^\top x}
  Ax+s = b+0 \\   Ax+s &= b+0 \\   Ax+s = b+0& \\
  x,s \ge 0   x,s &\ge 0   x,s \ge 0&
\end{lpalign}$$

Qualified Constraints

Qualified constraints are also possible. A double-ampersand `&&` will properly space and align a 'for-all' ($\forall$) statement.

```
\begin{lpalign*}{Maximize}{\sum_{j=1}^mc_jx_j}
  \mathbf{a}_i^\top\mathbf{x} &\le b_i
                    && \forall\ i\in [\![n]\!]      \\
     x_i &\ge 0     && \forall\ i\in \{1,2,...,n\}
```

$$\downarrow$$

$$\begin{lpalign*}{Maximize}{\sum_{j=1}^mc_jx_j}
  \mathbf{a}_i^\top\mathbf{x} &\le b_i
                    && \forall\ i\in [\![n]\!]   \\
     x_i &\ge 0   && \forall\ i\in \{1,2,...,n\}
\end{lpalign*}$$

Variable Ranges

Subscripts can be placed under the 'sense' term via the `vars` option.

```
\begin{lpalign*}[vars=\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{R}_+]
  {Maximize}{c_1x_1 + \dots + c_mx_m}
  A\mathbf{x} &\le \mathbf{b}
\end{lpalign*}
```

↓

$$\begin{aligned} \underset{\mathbf{x}\in\mathbb{R}_+}{\text{Maximize}} \quad & c_1x_1 + \cdots + c_mx_m \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & A\mathbf{x} \le \mathbf{b} \end{aligned}$$

Whitespace

The `sep` options can be used to modify the whitespace between elements. Their default values are mutable at package load.

```
\begin{lpalign}
[
objective-sep=2em,
qualifier-sep=4em,
gutter-sep=4em,
]
{Maximize}{\mathbf{c}^\top\mathbf{x}}
  A\mathbf{x} &\le \mathbf{b}  \\[2em]
   \mathbf{x} &\ge \mathbf{0}
\end{lpalign}
```

↓

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Maximize} \quad & \sum_{j=1}^{m} c_j x_j && && (4) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \mathbf{a}_i^\top \mathbf{x} \le b_i && \forall\ i \in [\![n]\!] && (5) \\ & x_i \ge 0 && \forall\ i \in \{1, 2, ..., n\} && (6) \end{aligned}$$

Remember that space can be added between individual rows (or lines of text) via an optional argument on `\\`.

Multiline Objectives

The objective function is wrapped in an aligned environment from amsmath. This means that very long objectives can easily be expressed in multiple lines rather than overflowing the margins or creating awkward spacing.

```
\begin{lpalign}{Maximize}
  {
    c_1&x_1+c_2x_2+c_3x_3+c_4x_4 \\
       &+c_5x_5+...+c_mx_m
  }
  \begin{aligned}
    a_{i1}&x_1+a_{i2}x_2+a_{i3}x_3 \\
          &+a_{i4}x_4+...+a_{im}x_nm
  \end{aligned} &\le b_i   && \forall\ i\in [\![n]\!]   \\
  \mathbf{x} &\ge \mathbf{0}
\end{lpalign}
```

↓

$$\text{Maximize} \quad \begin{aligned} & c_1 x_1 + c_2 x_2 + c_3 x_3 + c_4 x_4 \\ & + c_5 x_5 + ... + c_m x_m \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

$$\text{s.t.} \quad \begin{aligned} & a_{i1} x_1 + a_{i2} x_2 + a_{i3} x_3 \\ & + a_{i4} x_4 + ... + a_{im} x_n m \end{aligned} \le b_i \qquad \forall\ i \in [\![n]\!] \tag{8}$$

$$\mathbf{x} \ge \mathbf{0} \tag{9}$$

Multiline constraints can be displayed by nesting their own aligned environments in the constraint cells. Tags and qualifiers will be placed correctly.

The 'sense' and 'subject to' terms can be freely shifted up or down

```
\begin{lpalign}
  [ sense-shift=0.5\baselineskip,
    st-shift=0.5\baselineskip ]
  ...
  ...
\end{lpalign}
```

↓

$$\text{Maximize} \quad \begin{aligned} & c_1 x_1 + c_2 x_2 + c_3 x_3 + c_4 x_4 \\ & + c_5 x_5 + ... + c_m x_m \end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

$$\text{s.t.} \quad \begin{aligned} & a_1 x_1 + a_2 x_2 + a_3 x_3 \\ & + a_4 x_4 + ... + a_m x_m \end{aligned} \le b_i \tag{11}$$

3 Named Paragraphs

The `namedpara` command displays a paragraph marker that takes an abbreviation, which is useful for referencing specific problems or conventions.

```
\namedpara{Named Paragraph}[NPg]\label{npara1} \\
Paragraph \ref{npara1} is a named paragraph.
```

↓

Named Paragraph (NPg)
Paragraph NPg is a named paragraph.

Currently supported optional keys include

`abv` – abbreviation used when referencing. A single argument with no `=` sign is also interpreted as this abbreviation.

`indent` – indent distance. The default value of `2em` can be changed during package load by the `namedpara_indent` option.
e.g. `\usepackage[namedpara_indent=XXem]{lpalign}`.

`before` – arbitrary code placed between the indent and the title.

`after` – arbitrary code placed after the abbreviation.

`flush` – centers or right-flushes the paragraph title via `center` or `right`.

```
\namedpara{Indented}[abv=IND, indent=6em]

\namedpara{Surrounded}[abv=SUR, before=$>>>$, after=$<<<$]

\namedpara{Rightflushed}[abv=RIGHT, flush=right]
```

↓

Indented (IND)

>>>**Surrounded (SUR)**<<<

Rightflushed (RIGHT)

The compatibility command `paratitle` is left untouched from previous versions.

4 Named Sub-equations

The `namedsubeqs` environment uses a given name as the first index in any enclosed equation reference tag. A second index is appended as in a traditional `subequations` environment.

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}
\begin{align}
  A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}   \label{eq:1}   \\
  C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d}   \label{eq:2}
\end{align}
\end{namedsubeqs}

Equations \ref{eq:1} and \ref{eq:2} are equations.
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.a)}$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.b)}$$

Equations EQ.a and EQ.b are equations.

An optional argument allows you to change the style of the sub-tag. The currently supported keys are `style` for the second-index formatter (default `\alph`) and `punct` for the separator between the main tag and the sub-tag (default `.`).

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\roman]

                \begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\arabic]
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.i)} \qquad A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.1)}$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.ii)} \qquad C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.2)}$$

Fonts can be changed using the appropriate switch commands.

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\itshape\roman]

                \begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\scshape]
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.}i\text{)} \qquad A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.A)}$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.}ii\text{)} \qquad C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.B)}$$

The `punct` argument controls the separator between the main tag and the sub-tag.

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\scshape\roman, punct=:]

\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[style=\bfseries\arabic, punct=$\sim$]
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ:I)} \qquad A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ}\sim\mathbf{1}\text{)}$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ:II)} \qquad C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ}\sim\mathbf{2}\text{)}$$

A single optional argument which does not contain an `=` sign is interpreted as the `style` argument.

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[\sffamily\Alph]

                \begin{namedsubeqs}{EQ}[\bfseries\arabic]
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.A)} \qquad A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \quad \text{(EQ.A)}$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.B)} \qquad C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \quad \text{(EQ.B)}$$

5 Sub-References

Also available are `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref`, which work like `\ref` and `\eqref` but reference only the secondary, sub-index part of a tag inside either `namedsubeqs` or a traditional `subequations` environment from the amsmath package.

```
\begin{namedsubeqs}{SQ}[style=\itshape\roman]\label{nq}
\begin{align}
  A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}   \label{nq:1}\\
  C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d}   \label{nq:2}
\end{align}
\end{namedsubeqs}

Just like \ref{nq:1} and \eqref{nq:2}, we can reference
an equation's sub-tag \lpsubref{nq:1} and \lpsubeqref{nq:2}.
The environment itself may also be referenced \ref{nq}.
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \qquad (\text{SQ}.i)$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \qquad (\text{SQ}.ii)$$

Just like SQ.*i* and (SQ.*ii*), we can reference an equation's sub-tag *i* and (*ii*). The environment itself may also be referenced SQ.

`\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref` work with ordinary `\label` inside both `namedsubeqs` and traditional `subequations` environments. Other environments are not officially supported.

```
    \begin{subequations}\label{sq}
    \renewcommand{\theequation}
                    {\theparentequation\textbar\arabic{equation}}
    \begin{align}
      A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}   \label{sq:1}\\
      C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d}   \label{sq:2}
    \end{align}
    \end{subequations}

We can also reference \ref{sq}, \ref{sq:1} and \eqref{sq:2}, or
sub-reference \lpsubref{sq:1} and \lpsubeqref{sq:2} in a
\textsf{subequations} environment.
```

↓

$$A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} \qquad (12|1)$$
$$C\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{d} \qquad (12|2)$$

We can also reference 12, 12|1 and (12|2), or sub-reference 1 and (2) in a subequations environment.

Supported punctuation currently includes the period (.), colon (:), semicolon (;), comma (,), hyphen (-), forward slash (/), and `\textbar` (|). Other punctuation

has not been tested.

6 Combining Macros

Each of these macros may be combined for a nicely named, labeled, formatted and tagged mathematical programming problem.

```
\paratitle{Non-Linear Program}[NLP]\label{para:NLP}
\begin{namedsubeqs}{NLP}
\begin{lpalign}{Minimize}{f(\mathbf{x})    \label{NLP.0}}
  g_i(\mathbf{x}) &\GE 0 &&\forall\ i\in I \label{NLP.1} \\
  h_j(\mathbf{x}) &\EQ 0 &&\forall\ j\in J \label{NLP.2} \\
      \mathbf{x}  &\GE 0                 \label{NLP.3}
\end{lpalign}
\end{namedsubeqs}

Problem \eqref{para:NLP} is a nonlinear program.
Equation \eqref{NLP.0} is the objective function.
Equations (\ref{NLP.1}-\ref{NLP.3}) are the constraints.
Non-negativity is enforced by constraint \lpsubeqref{NLP.3}.
```

↓

Non-Linear Program (NLP)

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Minimize} \quad & f(\mathbf{x}) & & & \text{(NLP.}i\text{)} \\
\text{s.t.} \quad & g_i(\mathbf{x}) \geq 0 & & \forall\ i \in I & \text{(NLP.}ii\text{)} \\
& h_j(\mathbf{x}) = 0 & & \forall\ j \in J & \text{(NLP.}iii\text{)} \\
& \mathbf{x} \geq 0 & & & \text{(NLP.}iv\text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

Problem (NLP) is a nonlinear program. Equation (NLP.*i*) is the objective function. Equations (NLP.*ii*-*iv*) are the constraints. Non-negativity is enforced by constraint (*iv*).

7 Spacing Macros

Quick Spacing

Also included are font-relative versions of the common spacing commands `\quad` and `\qquad` and a few more for good measure:

- `\hskp` = 0.5em | |
- `\Hskp` = 1em | |
- `\HSkp` = 2em | |
- `\HSKp` = 3em | |
- `\HSKP` = 4em | |

Negative versions of the above spacing macros:

- `\htrg` = -0.5em
- `\Htrg` = -1em
- `\HTrg` = -2em
- `\HTRg` = -3em
- `\HTRG` = -4em

Vertical versions of the above horizontal spacing macros:

- `\vskp` = 0.5em
- `\Vskp` = 1em
- `\VSkp` = 2em
- `\VSKp` = 3em
- `\VSKP` = 4em
- `\vtrg` = -0.5em
- `\Vtrg` = -1em
- `\VTrg` = -2em
- `\VTRg` = -3em
- `\VTRG` = -4em

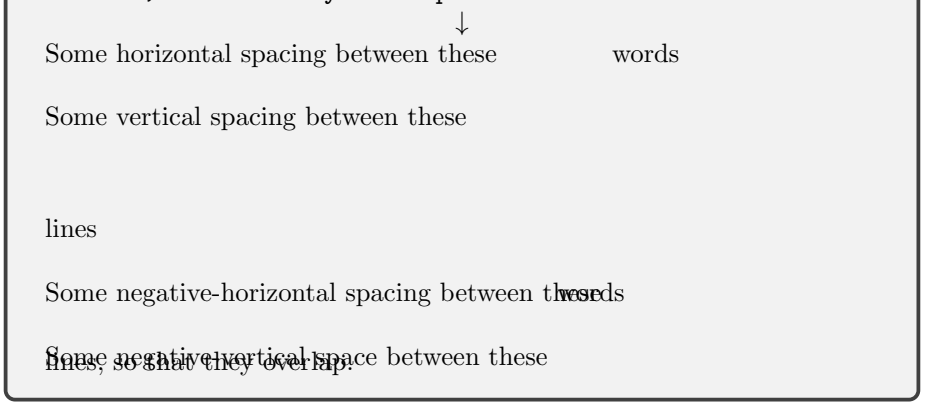
These are, I would say, less reliable than using `\vspace` or `\vskip` correctly, but I find them more convenient.

```
Some horizontal spacing between these \HSKP words \\

Some vertical spacing between these \VSKp lines \\

Some negative-horizontal spacing between these \HTrg words \\

Some negative-vertical space between these \Vtrg
lines, so that they overlap.
```



Delimiter Spacing

Some macros for tightening display-style operator spacing when the indexing is over-long. These preserve the usual subscript and superscript syntax while applying `\smashoperator` to the operator. They are meant for display math and are not generally useful inline.

- `\SUM` = $\sum$
- `\PROD` = $\prod$
- `\CUP` = $\bigcup$
- `\CAP` = $\bigcap$
- `\VEE` = $\bigvee$
- `\WEDGE` = $\bigwedge$

These operators now use the ordinary `_` and `^` syntax. This spacing is a personal preference; I think it makes things more consistent and legible. The example below is comically exaggerated; please use `\substack` to illuminate any *really* long indexing.

```
X=\sum_{i\in way too much indexing} x_i

                X=\VEE_{i\in way too much indexing} x_i

X=\CAP_{\substack{i\in way to \\ much indexing}} x_i

                  X=\PROD_{i=1,300,000}^{1,300,001} x_i
```

↓

$$X = \sum_{i \in waytoomuchindexing} x_i \qquad X = \bigwedge_{i \in waytoomuchindexing} x_i$$

$$X = \bigcap_{\substack{i \in wayto \\ muchindexing}} x_i \qquad X = \prod_{i=1,300,000}^{1,300,001} x_i$$

Evaluator Spacing

A few binary relations with extra space on either side. I like these for aligned equations or inequality constraints.

- `\EQ` $=$
- `\LS` $<$
- `\GS` $>$
- `\IN` $\in$
- `\LE` $\leq$
- `\GE` $\geq$
- `\NEQ` $\neq$
- `\SUB` $\subset$
- `\SUP` $\supset$
- `\NIN` $\notin$
- `\SEQ` $\subseteq$
- `\SPQ` $\supseteq$

```
Ax+s &\eq b \\
 x,s &\ge 0
```

```
Ax+s &\EQ b \\
   x,s &\GE 0
```

↓

$$\begin{aligned} \max \quad & c^\top x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax + s = b + 0 \\ & x, s \geq 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \max \quad & c^\top x \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & Ax + s \;=\; b + 0 \\ & x, s \;\geq\; 0 \end{aligned}$$

The spacing defaults to 0.25em is controlled by the package option `evaluator-spacing`.

8 Package Options

`evaluator-spacing` – Controls the padding on either side of the spaced evaluators. Defaults to `0.25em`. Section 7

9 Known Bugs

- ⊡ Very long objective functions may overrun the page. For now, use an embedded aligned environment to display a long function on multiple lines.
- ☒ Spacing macros `\quad` and `\qquad` overwrote default, absolute behavior with font-relative spacing. Fixed by renaming macros to `\Hskp` and `\HSkp`; v1.1.
- ☒ The package depended on makecell and vcell without using them. Fixed by removing those unused dependencies; v1.2.
- ☒ The `namedsubeqs` environment assigned `\currentlabel` without switching to `\makeatletter` scope. Fixed internally; v1.2.
- ☒ The `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref` macros failed outright when hyperref was not loaded. Fixed by falling back to plain text references when hyperref is absent; v1.2.
- ☒ When hyperref was loaded, `\sublabel` could produce duplicate equation destinations or occasionally link to the wrong tag. Fixed by assigning dedicated hyperref-facing equation identifiers and by removing a redundant equation-counter decrement at the end of namedsubeqs; test branch after v1.2.
- ☒ Ordinary `\label` now works for `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref` inside both `namedsubeqs` and traditional subequations. Fixed on the test branch after v1.2.
- ☒ The public commands `\subref` and `\subeqref` conflicted with packages such as subcaption. Fixed by renaming the package commands to `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref`; v1.3.
- ☒ The objective function did not contribute correctly to the width of the environment. Fixed in v1.4 final.

10 Version History

v1.0 Dec. 20, 2025. Initial distribution. Includes lpalign and namedsubeqs environments along with macros for named paragraphs and spacing.

v1.1 Jan. 30, 2026. Bug fix. Renamed quick spacing macros to maintain compatibility with standard TEX. Added negative, vertical and negative-vertical versions. Added summation spacing macros. Added clause alignment arguments to the lpalign environment.

v1.2 Jun. 25, 2026. Bug fix. Removed unused package dependencies, fixed the internal `\currentlabel` handling in namedsubeqs, added a no-hyperref fallback for `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref`, and added `\lpsubref`/`\lpsubeqref`

support for the traditional subequations environment from amsmath.

v1.3 Jun. 26, 2026. Feature and compatibility update. Added `\namedpara` with key-value options, namespaced the sub-equation reference commands as `\lpsubref` and `\lpsubeqref`, and hardened parent-label handling for both `namedsubeqs` and traditional subequations.

v1.4 final Jun. 28, 2026. Layout and defaults update. Reworked lpalign so the objective contributes correctly to the environment width, ordinary rows no longer need trailing `&&` placeholders, package-load defaults are now available for `objective-sep`, `qualifier-sep` and `gutter-sep`, and the operator helpers now preserve standard `_/^` syntax.